

KINGS OF BOOKINGS
1: Hyundai Creta 2: Mahindra Scorpio-N 3: Tata Nano



1.15 lakh bookings for one of the biggest successes in the Indian automotive industry, the Creta. However, these numbers have been racked up over a period, with demand far outstripping supply, leading to huge waiting periods for the Creta in particular.

Now there is the Mahindra Scorpio-N that has garnered over a lakh bookings within the first 30 minutes of the window opening—over 25,000 cars were booked within the first minute! Buyers were no doubt spurred by the long waiting period of nearly two years for the XUV 700 and one year for the Thar. Also motivating them would have been the fact that introductory prices were offered to only the first 25,000 bookings.

Introductory prices have helped in getting record numbers of bookings. A fantastic introductory price of Rs 4.99 lakh from Nissan saw the Magnite rake up the numbers, with the car attracting over 30,000 bookings within a month. The figure rose, crossing 70,000 in two months. Impressive for a company that was struggling to survive in the country.

But in all these cases, customers know the price of the car, unlike those who are booking the new Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara, for which bookings or as firms now like to call them, 'pre-bookings', are coming in without the company having announced the SUV's price. With huge numbers of pre-bookings coming in, it will be interesting to note how many people carry their bookings forward once the prices are announced.

Given the past experiences of the industry, a huge number of bookings is no guarantee of big sales and profits. However, more often than not, it does translate into success stories. ■

